Project Reflection

Project 003 – Named Entity Recognition (NER)

1. Overview

This project provided practical experience in Named Entity Recognition (NER), one of the most common annotation tasks used in Natural Language Processing (NLP). Although identifying entities appears straightforward at first glance, the project demonstrated that high-quality annotation depends on careful attention to detail, consistent application of annotation guidelines, and thorough quality assurance. Annotating 150 samples across multiple domains required sustained focus and highlighted the importance of consistency throughout the annotation process.

2. What I Learned

One of the most valuable lessons from this project was the importance of precise entity boundaries. Small differences in span selection, such as including or excluding articles ('The') or possessive endings ('s), can affect dataset consistency and model performance.

The project also reinforced the need to distinguish between entity types that may appear similar in context, such as organizations, locations, products, and events. Developing clear annotation rules for these situations improved consistency across the dataset.

Another important takeaway was that annotation is an iterative process. Initial assumptions were occasionally refined through quality assurance reviews, resulting in clearer guidelines and more consistent annotations.

3. Challenges Encountered

While most entities were correctly identified, a minor transcription oversight - such as omitted labels – was spotted during quality assurance and corrected before finalizing the dataset. This made me to always double check my work.

4. Skills Developed

Completing this project strengthened several practical skills relevant to AI data annotation and NLP:

- Named Entity Recognition (NER)
- Span-based annotation
- Entity classification
- Annotation guideline interpretation

- Quality assurance and review
- Documentation and reporting
- Attention to detail

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5. Future Improvements

If this project were expanded further, additional entity categories could be introduced to support more complex NER tasks. Future versions could also include inter-annotator agreement (IAA) analysis, larger datasets, and annotations from multiple reviewers to further evaluate consistency and annotation quality.